CDL School Bus Endorsement Questions and Answers

45 practice questions with answers and explanations, grouped by topic

Written from the Commercial Driver's License Manual (Version 07/20/2026 (form DMV 60A), AAMVA, Virginia DMV edition). Each answer names the manual section it comes from.

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How to use this PDF: answer the questions in Part 1 first, then check yourself with the answer key in Part 2.

Passing score on each CDL knowledge test: at least 80% correct (49 CFR 383.135).

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Part 1: Questions

Danger zones and mirrors (6 questions)

1. When should you check each mirror to get the maximum viewing area?

- **A.** Before you operate the school bus
- **B.** After you finish the first stop of the route
- **C.** Only when you return to the bus lot
- **D.** Only when another driver has used the bus

2. What should you keep in mind about the view in the outside convex mirrors?

- **A.** It shows people and objects at their exact size and distance
- **B.** It does not show the true size and distance of people and objects
- **C.** It shows only the area directly in front of the front bumper
- **D.** It shows only the passengers seated inside the bus

3. Which mirrors must you use to watch traffic approaching the large blind spot behind the bus?

- **A.** The overhead inside rearview mirror
- **B.** A mirror mounted on the rear emergency door
- **C.** The exterior side mirrors
- **D.** A small mirror above the service door

4. Why is the area to the left of a school bus always considered dangerous?

- **A.** Students usually line up on that side
- **B.** The service door opens on that side
- **C.** Cars may be passing the bus on that side
- **D.** The fuel tank is mounted on that side

5. **How should the crossover, convex and flat mirrors be viewed to make sure no child is in a danger zone?**
   - **A.** In a logical sequence, one after another
   - **B.** Only the crossover mirrors, at each stop
   - **C.** Only the flat mirrors, while the bus moves
   - **D.** In any order, whenever there is time

6. **Depending on the length and width of the bus, how far can the blind spot behind the bus extend?**
   - **A.** Up to 30 feet
   - **B.** Up to 1,000 feet
   - **C.** Up to 10 feet
   - **D.** Up to 400 feet

Loading and unloading (14 questions)

7. **What do you need before you change the location of a school bus stop?**
   - **A.** Spoken agreement from the parents at that stop
   - **B.** A vote of the students who use that stop
   - **C.** Approval from another school bus driver
   - **D.** Written approval from the appropriate district official

8. **When students who must cross the road reach the edge of the roadway, what should they check on the bus?**
   - **A.** Whether the service door has closed
   - **B.** Whether the red flashing lights are still flashing
   - **C.** Whether the engine is still running
   - **D.** Whether the stop arm has folded back in

9. **After crossing in front of the bus on your signal, where should students stop and look again for your signal?**
   - **A.** At the center line, before the next lane
   - **B.** At the right front corner of the bumper
   - **C.** Beside the service door of the bus
   - **D.** At the left edge of the school bus

10. **Each year, in which situation are more students killed?**
    - **A.** Riding as passengers inside a school bus
    - **B.** Getting on or off a school bus
    - **C.** Riding in the front seats of a school bus
    - **D.** Riding in the rear seats of a school bus

11. **What should students be told to do if they drop an object near the bus?**
    - **A.** Leave it, move out of the danger zones and get the driver's attention
    - **B.** Pick it up quickly, before the bus begins to move away
    - **C.** Reach under the bus for it while the door is still open
    - **D.** Go back for it as soon as the bus door has closed

12. Before you completely open the door and signal students to approach, what should your final check confirm?

A. That the dome light is turned on
B. That every student has a seat partner
C. That the engine has been turned off
D. That all traffic has stopped

13. What is the danger known as a handrail hang-up?

A. A student slipping on a wet step while boarding
B. A handrail that comes loose from the stepwell
C. A student blocking the door while others wait
D. Clothing, accessories or body parts caught in the handrail or door

14. You realize you have driven past a student's unloading stop. What should you do?

A. Do not back up; follow local procedures
B. Back up slowly while using the mirrors
C. Let the student off at the next corner
D. Back up only if no traffic is behind you

15. While loading at a stop, you notice that a student who should be there is missing. What should you do?

A. Leave right away so the route stays on time
B. Ask the other students where the student is
C. Honk the horn and wait at least ten minutes
D. Drive around the block and come back later

16. During a post-trip inspection, which items unique to school buses deserve special attention?

A. Seat covers, floor mats and window shades
B. Mirror systems, flashing warning lamps and stop signal arms
C. Radio, heater and interior dome lights
D. Fuel cap, battery box and mud flaps

17. When approaching a stop, about how far before pulling over should you turn on the right turn signal?

A. About 100-300 feet, or about 3-5 seconds
B. About 500-600 feet, or about 10-15 seconds
C. About 20-50 feet, or about 1 second
D. Only after the bus has come to a full stop

18. When unloading at school, what should you watch for as students step off the bus?

A. That each one shows a bus pass at the door
B. That they line up beside the front bumper
C. That all of them move promptly away from the unloading area
D. That they wait by the door until the bus leaves

19. When you stop at a designated stop, how far from the waiting students should the front bumper be?

- **A.** Right beside the students, so they take few steps
- **B.** At least 3 feet away from the students
- **C.** At least 10 feet away from the students
- **D.** At least 50 feet away from the students

20. During loading, you cannot account for a student outside the bus. What should you do?

- **A.** Pull ahead slowly while watching the mirrors
- **B.** Sound the horn and then continue the route
- **C.** Secure the bus, take the key, and check around and under it
- **D.** Ask a student to walk around the bus and look

Emergency exit and evacuation (7 questions)

21. If time permits, what should you do before deciding whether to evacuate the bus?

- **A.** Ask the students to vote on leaving the bus
- **B.** Contact your dispatcher to explain the situation
- **C.** Drive the bus to the nearest school
- **D.** Wait for a police officer to arrive

22. During an evacuation, what should you do with a radio microphone or telephone that still works?

- **A.** Dangle it out of the driver's window for later use
- **B.** Switch it off and leave it on the driver's seat
- **C.** Lock it inside the driver's compartment
- **D.** Give it to the student assistant at the rear exit

23. As a general rule, how are student safety and control best kept during an emergency?

- **A.** By sending students to the nearest house at once
- **B.** By having students wait outside beside the bus
- **C.** By keeping students on the bus unless that exposes them to needless risk
- **D.** By letting older students decide where everyone goes

24. If there is a risk from spilled hazardous materials, where should you lead the students?

- **A.** Downwind of the bus, at least 100 feet
- **B.** Back onto the bus with the windows open
- **C.** Upwind of the bus, at least 300 feet
- **D.** Upwind of the bus, about 25 feet

25. When should you move a student you believe may have a neck or spinal injury?

- **A.** As soon as all other students are off the bus
- **B.** Only if the student's life is in immediate danger
- **C.** Only after the student says the pain is gone
- **D.** Whenever the bus must be evacuated

26. According to the manual's tips, where is a safe place for students after an evacuation?

- **A.** Right next to the bus on the shoulder
- **B.** At least 25 feet behind the bus
- **C.** At least 50 feet ahead of the bus on the shoulder
- **D.** At least 100 feet off the road toward oncoming traffic

27. When possible, how many student assistants should be assigned to each emergency exit?

- **A.** Two responsible, older students
- **B.** One student from each row of seats
- **C.** Four students of any age
- **D.** Only the student seated nearest the exit

Railroad-highway crossings (7 questions)

28. As a general rule, how do you work out an acceptable containment or storage area on the far side of a crossing?

- **A.** Add 5 feet to the length of the bus
- **B.** Add 15 feet to the length of the bus
- **C.** Double the length of the bus
- **D.** Use the length of the bus with nothing added

29. The crossing gate comes down after you have started across the tracks. What should you do?

- **A.** Stop and back up off the tracks
- **B.** Stop where you are and wait for the gate
- **C.** Stop and have the students get off
- **D.** Keep going and drive through the gate

30. The train has passed, but the crossing gate stays down. What should you do?

- **A.** Drive carefully around the end of the gate
- **B.** Back up and use the lane on the other side
- **C.** Do not drive around it; call your dispatcher
- **D.** Raise the gate by hand and drive through

31. When approaching a railroad crossing, about how far before it should you activate the hazard lights?

- **A.** About 50 feet before the crossing
- **B.** About 200 feet before the crossing
- **C.** About 1,000 feet before the crossing
- **D.** Only once the bus has stopped

32. At a multiple-track crossing, where should the school bus stop?

- **A.** Only before the first set of tracks
- **B.** Before each set of tracks
- **C.** Between the last two sets of tracks
- **D.** Only after crossing the first set of tracks

33. Your bus stalls on the tracks and everyone gets out. Which way should they move?

- **A.** Straight along the tracks, away from the train
- **B.** Just off the tracks, next to the bus
- **C.** Far from the bus at an angle away from the tracks and toward the train
- **D.** Back to the nearest crossing signal to wait

34. At a railroad crossing with no white stop line painted on the pavement, where must you stop the bus?

- **A.** After the first set of tracks
- **B.** Just past the cross-buck sign
- **C.** With the front bumper over the near rail
- **D.** Before the cross-buck sign

Student management (3 questions)

35. A behavior problem starts on the bus while students are unloading. When should you deal with it?

- **A.** Right away, while the door is still open
- **B.** Before any more students are let off
- **C.** At the end of the route, without stopping
- **D.** After the unloading students are safely off and have moved away

36. Where are you allowed to put a student off the bus?

- **A.** At the nearest safe intersection
- **B.** At any business with a telephone
- **C.** Only at school or the student's designated bus stop
- **D.** At any parking lot off the road

37. If a misbehaving student needs a change of seating, where should you ask the student to sit?

- **A.** In a seat near you
- **B.** In the very last row
- **C.** In any empty seat they choose
- **D.** Next to a student assistant

Antilock brakes (4 questions)

38. Hydraulically braked trucks and buses with a GVWR of 10,000 lbs or more must have ABS if built on or after which date?

- **A.** March 1, 1998
- **B.** March 1, 1999
- **C.** January 1, 1995
- **D.** January 1, 2005

39. Your bus's ABS malfunctions. What should you do?

- **A.** Drive normally and get the system serviced soon
- **B.** Stop at once and call for a tow truck
- **C.** Pump the brakes at every stop until repaired
- **D.** Keep your speed under 5 mph until repaired

40. Which kind of skid should ABS help prevent?

- **A.** A skid from spinning the drive wheels
- **B.** A skid from going too fast in a turn
- **C.** A skid caused by braking too hard
- **D.** Any skid, no matter what causes it

41. Braking hard on a slippery surface without ABS, what happens if your steering wheels lock up?

- **A.** The bus stops in a much shorter distance
- **B.** The rear of the bus always swings left
- **C.** The engine automatically shuts off
- **D.** You lose steering control

Special safety considerations (4 questions)

42. If you must back a school bus, what is the purpose of the lookout?

- **A.** To give you steering directions while you back
- **B.** To keep the students on the bus quiet
- **C.** To stop traffic in both directions
- **D.** To warn you about obstacles, approaching people and other vehicles

43. You are caught in strong winds while driving the school bus. What should you do?

- **A.** Slow down, or pull off the roadway and wait
- **B.** Speed up to get through the windy area sooner
- **C.** Loosen your grip so the bus can drift with gusts
- **D.** Move to the left lane to stay off the shoulder

44. If your bus has a roof-mounted white strobe light, when should you use it?

- **A.** Only while students are loading at school
- **B.** When you have limited visibility
- **C.** Only when crossing railroad tracks
- **D.** Whenever the bus is parked at night

45. How much tail swing can a school bus have?

- **A.** Up to one foot
- **B.** Up to ten feet
- **C.** Up to three feet
- **D.** Up to six inches

Part 2: Answer key

Each answer has a short explanation in our own words and the CDL manual section it comes from. Reread that section for every question you missed.

Danger zones and mirrors

1. **A. Before you operate the school bus**
   Every mirror is checked before you drive so you start with the widest possible view of the danger zones; a mirror that is off should be adjusted.
   Manual section 10.1.2 Correct Mirror Adjustment

2. **B. It does not show the true size and distance of people and objects**
   Convex mirrors give a wide-angle view of the sides, so what you see in them is not a true picture of how big or how far away something is.
   Manual section 10.1.4 Outside Left and Right Side Convex Mirrors

3. **C. The exterior side mirrors**
   The inside rearview mirror is for watching passengers and cannot cover the long blind area behind the bus, so traffic coming into that area is watched with the outside side mirrors.
   Manual section 10.1.6 Overhead Inside Rearview Mirror

4. **C. Cars may be passing the bus on that side**
   Traffic goes by the bus on its left, so the manual treats that whole area as a constant danger to children near the bus.
   Manual section 10.1.1 Danger Zones

5. **A. In a logical sequence, one after another**
   The three mirror types work together to cover the danger zones, so you look through them in a set order each time so that no child or object is missed.
   Manual section 10.1.5 Outside Left and Right Side Crossover Mirrors

6. **D. Up to 400 feet**
   The area behind the bus that the outside flat mirrors cannot show is long, and on a long, wide bus it can reach about 400 feet.
   Manual section 10.1.3 Outside Left and Right Side Flat Mirrors

Loading and unloading

7. **D. Written approval from the appropriate district official**
   School districts set the official routes and stops, so a driver may move a stop only with written permission from the proper district official.
   Manual section 10.2.1 Approaching the Stop

8. **B. Whether the red flashing lights are still flashing**
   At the road edge, students look in all directions, confirm the bus's red flashing lights are still on, and then wait for the driver's signal before crossing.
   Manual section 10.2.3 Unloading Procedures on the Route

9. **D. At the left edge of the school bus**
   Students pause again when they reach the bus's left edge and wait for a second signal from the driver before crossing the rest of the road.
   Manual section 10.2.3 Unloading Procedures on the Route

10. **B. Getting on or off a school bus**
    Loading and unloading is the deadliest part of school bus travel, with more student deaths than among passengers riding inside the bus.
    Manual section 10.2 Loading and Unloading

11. **A. Leave it, move out of the danger zones and get the driver's attention**
Stopping or turning back for a dropped item can take a student out of the driver's sight at a dangerous moment, so the student should get to a safe spot and signal the driver instead.
Manual section 10.2.5 Special Dangers of Loading and Unloading

12. **D. That all traffic has stopped**
Students are called to the bus only after you have made sure that every vehicle around the bus has come to a stop.
Manual section 10.2.1 Approaching the Stop

13. **D. Clothing, accessories or body parts caught in the handrail or door**
Students getting off the bus can be snagged by the handrail or door, which has caused injuries and deaths, so watch each one reach a safe spot before you move the bus.
Manual section 10.2.5 Special Dangers of Loading and Unloading

14. **A. Do not back up; follow local procedures**
Backing up to reach a missed stop is not allowed; you handle the missed stop the way your local procedures direct.
Manual section 10.2.3 Unloading Procedures on the Route

15. **B. Ask the other students where the student is**
Counting riders and knowing who belongs at each stop helps you notice a missing student, and the students who are there may know where that student is.
Manual section 10.2.2 Loading Procedures

16. **B. Mirror systems, flashing warning lamps and stop signal arms**
When looking for mechanical problems after a route or trip, focus on the equipment that sets a school bus apart: its mirror system, warning lamps and stop arms.
Manual section 10.2.6 Post-trip Inspection

17. **A. About 100-300 feet, or about 3-5 seconds**
The right signal goes on roughly 100 to 300 feet, or 3 to 5 seconds, ahead of pulling over, which tells others you are about to stop.
Manual section 10.2.1 Approaching the Stop

18. **C. That all of them move promptly away from the unloading area**
As students leave the bus at school, you watch each one get clear of the unloading area without delay.
Manual section 10.2.4 Unloading Procedures at School

19. **C. At least 10 feet away from the students**
Stopping 10 feet or more short of the students makes them walk up to the bus, which gives you a better view of where they are going.
Manual section 10.2.1 Approaching the Stop

20. **C. Secure the bus, take the key, and check around and under it**
A missing student could be beside or beneath the bus, so you make the bus safe, keep the key with you and look around and under it yourself.
Manual section 10.2.2 Loading Procedures

Emergency exit and evacuation

21. **B. Contact your dispatcher to explain the situation**
When there is time, a call to dispatch describing what is happening should come before you make the evacuation decision.
Manual section 10.3.1 Planning for Emergencies

22. **A. Dangle it out of the driver's window for later use**
Hanging a working radio microphone or phone outside the driver's window keeps it available to use later on.
Manual section 10.3.2 Evacuation Procedures

23. C. By keeping students on the bus unless that exposes them to needless risk

Students are usually safest and easiest to manage on the bus, as long as staying there does not put them at unnecessary risk; any decision to leave must be made in time.

Manual section 10.3.1 Planning for Emergencies

24. C. Upwind of the bus, at least 300 feet

With a hazardous materials spill, students are taken upwind and kept a long way off, no less than 300 feet from the bus.

Manual section 10.3.2 Evacuation Procedures

25. B. Only if the student's life is in immediate danger

A student who may have a neck or spine injury stays where they are unless staying would put their life at immediate risk, and special procedures are needed to move such a victim.

Manual section 10.3.2 Evacuation Procedures

26. D. At least 100 feet off the road toward oncoming traffic

Moving students well off the road on the side that traffic comes from keeps them out of reach of debris if another vehicle hits the bus.

Manual section 10.3.2 Evacuation Procedures

27. A. Two responsible, older students

Planning ahead means choosing two mature, reliable students for every emergency exit and teaching them how to help the others off the bus.

Manual section 10.3.2 Evacuation Procedures

Railroad-highway crossings

28. B. Add 15 feet to the length of the bus

To be sure the whole bus can clear the tracks if it has to stop on the other side, you need room equal to the bus length plus 15 feet.

Manual section 10.4.4 Special Situations

29. D. Keep going and drive through the gate

Once the bus is crossing, keep moving until the tracks are cleared, even if that means breaking the gate arm.

Manual section 10.4.3 Recommended Procedures

30. C. Do not drive around it; call your dispatcher

A gate that does not rise after the train goes by is never a reason to go around it; contact your dispatcher instead.

Manual section 10.4.2 Warning Signs and Devices

31. B. About 200 feet before the crossing

Turning on the hazard lights roughly 200 feet out lets other drivers know that you plan to stop at the crossing.

Manual section 10.4.3 Recommended Procedures

32. A. Only before the first set of tracks

You stop once, ahead of the first track, and when you are sure no train is coming on any track you cross all of them until the bus is fully clear.

Manual section 10.4.3 Recommended Procedures

33. C. Far from the bus at an angle away from the tracks and toward the train

Everyone gets off the tracks at once and goes well away from the bus, angling both off the tracks and in the direction the train is coming from.

Manual section 10.4.4 Special Situations

34. D. Before the cross-buck sign

When there is no painted stop line to guide you, the cross-buck sign marks the point that the bus must stop in front of.

Manual section 10.4.2 Warning Signs and Devices

Student management

35. D. After the unloading students are safely off and have moved away

Loading and unloading need all of your attention outside the bus, so the problem waits until the departing students are clear; pull over to handle it if needed.

Manual section 10.5.1 Don't Deal with On-bus Problems When Loading and Unloading

36. C. Only at school or the student's designated bus stop

Even when a student misbehaves, the student leaves the bus only at school or at that student's own stop; if you cannot drive safely, call an administrator or the police to remove the student.

Manual section 10.5.2 Handling Serious Problems

37. A. In a seat near you

The manual's tip for a needed seat change is to have the student move up to a seat close to the driver.

Manual section 10.5.2 Handling Serious Problems

Antilock brakes

38. B. March 1, 1999

The ABS rule for hydraulic-brake trucks and buses of 10,000 pounds GVWR or more covers vehicles built from March 1, 1999; the date for air brake vehicles is a year earlier.

Manual section 10.6.1 Vehicles Required to Have Antilock Braking Systems

39. A. Drive normally and get the system serviced soon

A failed ABS still leaves the normal brakes working, so you can keep driving as usual, but the system should be repaired soon.

Manual section 10.6.4 Braking if ABS is Not Working

40. C. A skid caused by braking too hard

ABS works against skids that come from over-braking, but it does nothing about power skids or skids from taking a turn too fast.

Manual section 10.6.5 Safety Reminders

41. D. You lose steering control

Once the steering wheels lock, they can no longer steer the bus, and ABS helps by keeping the wheels from locking so you stay in control.

Manual section 10.6.2 How ABS Helps You

Special safety considerations

42. D. To warn you about obstacles, approaching people and other vehicles

The lookout only alerts you to hazards around the bus; the lookout is not supposed to tell you how to back the bus.

Manual section 10.7.3 Backing

43. A. Slow down, or pull off the roadway and wait

Lower speed reduces how much the wind pushes on the side of the bus; if needed, get off the road and wait, and keep a firm grip on the wheel.

Manual section 10.7.2 Driving in High Winds

44. B. When you have limited visibility

The overhead strobe is meant for times when you cannot easily see what is around the bus, always following your state or local rules for its use.

Manual section 10.7.1 Strobe Lights

45. **C. Up to three feet**

The rear of a school bus can swing out as much as three feet, so check your mirrors before and during every turn.

Manual section 10.7.4 Tail Swing

Keep practicing online

This list with a hide-answers switch: https://cdl-testprep.com/cdl-practice-test/school-bus/questions-and-answers/
Every CDL practice test: https://cdl-testprep.com/cdl-practice-test/